Boord Notes

Training Guide

How to capture, find and act on farm knowledge on your iPhone.

For Andre and his son.

For app version 2.16 · October 2026

1. What Boord Notes is for

Boord Notes is a private notebook for farm knowledge: how a job is done, what an odd piece of equipment does, what you saw in a block and what it needs. Anything worth handing on goes in, so it is all in one place later.

- **Speak or type.** For Afrikaans, tap **Record in Afrikaans**. For English, use the microphone on your iPhone keyboard. The note keeps only the text: a recording is deleted once it has become words.
- **From what you see to what gets done.** A note can carry **actions** - prune, fertilise with LAN, water more, pick. They go on the **To do** list until someone ticks them off, and the note then records when it was done.
- **Works without signal.** A note saves on the phone first and reaches the server by itself once there is signal again.
- **No sign-in.** The app opens straight onto the Capture screen. Anyone who can reach it can read, edit and archive notes, so keep the phone in the right hands.

A note holds a title, the notes text, a block (or any other spot), any number of actions, tags and photos. It also records where you were and the weather when you first saved it.

2. Setting up the phone (once)

> **Install to the Home Screen before you capture anything.** Notes written in a Safari tab are stored separately from the installed app and will look as if they have vanished. Install first, then always open the app from its icon.

1. Make sure the **Tailscale** app is installed and signed in on the phone.
2. Open the farm's address in Safari: **https://<server>.<tailnet>.ts.net:9443/app/** (ask whoever set up the server for the exact link).
3. Tap **Share** (square with an arrow), then **Add to Home Screen**.
4. From now on open **Notes** from its Home Screen icon (Boord crate with a sky-blue leaf).
5. When asked, allow **Location** and **Camera** access.

> Both of you use the same link. There is one address and no accounts.

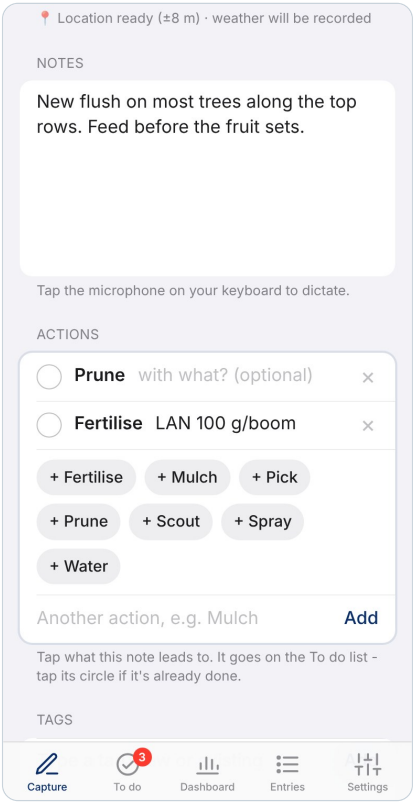
Once, for the farm: add the blocks in **Settings** → **Blocks** (section 7). Until then the Block field on a note is a plain text box.

3. Capturing a note

The app looks and works like an iPhone app. The tabs along the bottom are **Capture**, **To do**, **Dashboard**, **Notes**, **Ask AI** (only when AI help is switched on) and **Settings**. The app opens on Capture. It follows the

phone's own light or dark setting. Dates read year/month/day (2026/08/21) and times use the 24-hour clock (14:05) on every phone.

1. **Title.** Keep it short, e.g. "Flush on 8b".
2. **Block.** Tap it and pick from the farm's blocks, grouped by type (e.g. TMR: 8a, 8b). For anywhere else choose **Somewhere else…** and type it, e.g. "near the pump station".
3. **Notes.** In Afrikaans, tap **Record in Afrikaans** under the field, speak, and tap **Stop recording**; the words appear a few seconds later. With no signal, just save the note: the words are added when the phone next reaches the server. In English, tap the field, then the **microphone key** next to the space bar, and **Done** to stop. Read it over and fix any mistakes. If AI help is on, **AI Tidy up** can clean it up for you (section 6).
4. **Actions** NEW. What does this note lead to? Tap **+ Prune**, **+ Fertilise**, **+ Water** and so on, then type *with what* if it matters, e.g. "LAN 100 g/boom". Add as many as needed. Each one goes on the To do list. If it has **already been done**, tap its circle so it shows a green tick.
5. **Tags.** Tap **Choose from existing tags** and tap each one that fits, or type a new one and tap **Add**.
6. **Photos.** Tap **Add Photo** and choose **Camera**, **Photo Library** or **Files**. Photos are shrunk on the phone so they send quickly.
7. Tap **Save Note**.



A note with two actions to do

Good notes lead to actions

Write down what you see, and then what it means for the block. A few examples:

You see	Action on the note
New flush on the trees	Prune - To do
Fruit at a stage that needs feeding	Fertilise with LAN 200 g/tree - To do
TMR litchis that look ready	Pick - To do
Leaf colour shows stress	Water, extra 2 hours - To do (and maybe Fertilise if it is the soil)
"I sprayed 8a this morning"	Spray with … - tap the circle: already done

Location and weather

The line under **Record location** says whether a GPS fix is ready ("Location ready" or "No location available"). Saving never waits for it. The **Record location** switch turns this off if you do not want it.

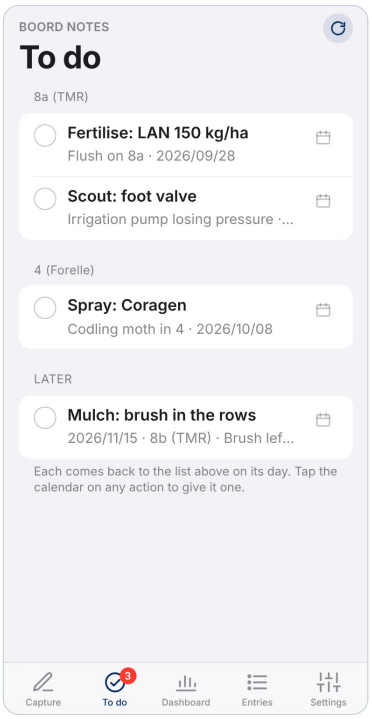
- Location works with no signal. Weather does not, and is left blank rather than filled in later.
- Both are recorded once, when the note is first created. Editing later does not change them.

> **Tip for Afrikaans.** The iPhone keyboard's microphone has no Afrikaans and turns it into garbled English, so always use **Record in Afrikaans**. The first time, allow the app to use the microphone.

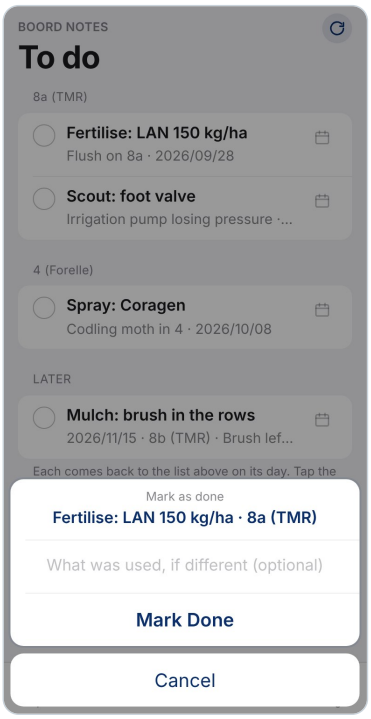
4. The To do list NEW

The **To do** tab lists every action still waiting, grouped by block, with the ones that have waited longest at the top. The red number on the tab is how many are open. Tap the rest of a row to open its note.

Not yet? Tap the small calendar on a row to put the job off - **Tomorrow**, **In a week**, **In a month** or a date. It waits under **Later** at the bottom of the list, and comes back to the list by itself on that day. **No set day** brings it back at once.



Open actions by block



Marking one done

When the job is done: tap the circle next to it. A small panel asks *What was used, if different* - fill it in if the plan changed (e.g. "used MAP instead"), or leave it empty. Tap **Mark Done**. The action leaves the list and the note now shows it done, with the date.

You can also tick actions off from inside a note. Ticking off works without signal too - it is sent with the next sync, dated when you ticked it.

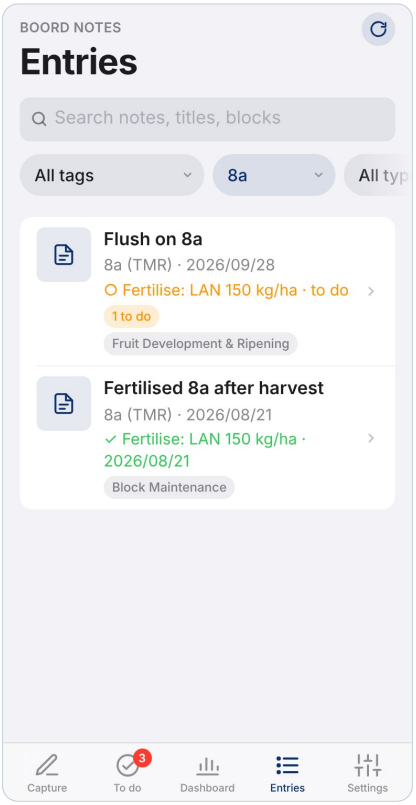
5. Finding and reviewing notes

Notes

Search by title, notes text or block - the start of a word is enough, in any case and with or without the accents, so "spuit" finds "Spuitprogram". Below the search are filter buttons: **tag**, **block**, **type** (every block of that variety) and **action**. A note with open actions shows "2 to do" on its card. The round arrow at the top right pulls in what the other phone has added.

A block's history. Choose a block and an action together - say **8a** and **Fertilise** - to see every fertilising of 8a. Each note then shows how that action stands: a green tick with the date it was done and anything noted, or "to do".

Opening a note. Tap it. It slides up from the bottom with its block, actions, tags, notes and photos. Tap **Done** (top right) or the dimmed area above it to close it. Tap the coordinates to open the spot in your map app, handy for walking back to a particular tree.



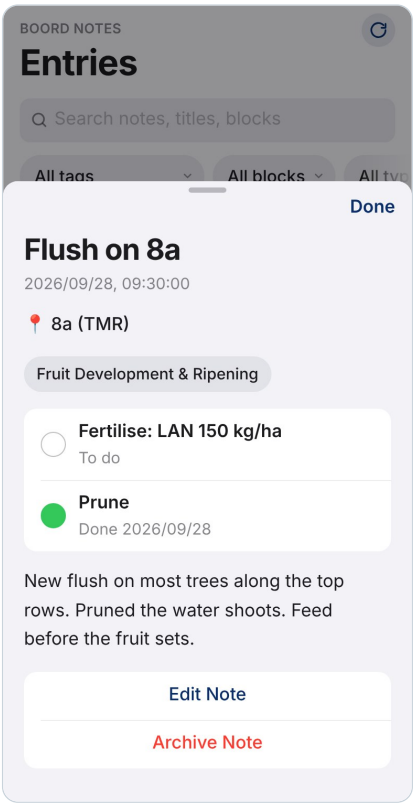
8a + Fertilise: the block's history

Dashboard

A quick summary: total notes, notes this week, how many have photos, tags in use, a count per tag, and the latest notes.

Editing and archiving

Button	What it does
Edit Note	Reopens the note in the Capture form with everything filled in, actions included. Location and weather stay as first recorded.
Archive Note	Hides the note from lists, search and the To do list. Nothing is erased: **Settings → Archived notes** lists them, each with **Restore**.



A note: one action to do, one done

6. AI help (optional)

These two buttons appear only once the server has been given an AI key, and they need signal. Without them, everything else works exactly the same.

- **AI Tidy up** (under Notes on Capture) adds punctuation and paragraphs to dictated text and suggests a title, tags and **actions** - "ons gaan die blok meer natlei" becomes *+ Water*. It keeps Afrikaans as Afrikaans and does not add facts. Nothing changes until you tap **Use this** for the text, or tap a suggested tag or action to add it. **Keep mine** throws the suggestion away.
- **Ask AI** (its own tab) answers questions from the saved notes only, in English or Afrikaans - for example "When did we last fertilise 8a?" - and lists the notes it used.

> Always read an AI suggestion before using it. It can still get a word wrong, and it only knows what is in the notes.

7. Settings

Card	What it is for
Tags	Every tag with how many notes use it. Add new ones with **Add**. **Remove** appears only on tags no note uses.
Actions NEW	The actions offered on Capture: Spray, Water, Fertilise, Prune, Pick, Scout to start with. Add others (e.g. Mulch) here or straight from a note.
Blocks	The farm's blocks, each with its type (variety, e.g. TMR). Type the name and type, then **Add Block**. **Edit** fixes a name or type, and a new name moves onto all its notes. Block names typed on older notes are listed under **On notes, but not on the list** - tap **Add to List**.
Backups	Make a backup now and download earlier ones (section 9).

"pruning" and "Pruning" count as the same name everywhere, so a tag, action or block cannot be split in two by a capital letter.

8. Working without signal

Every save goes onto the phone first, so it always works. In the background the app then sends notes to the server, and only afterwards their photos. It tries again about every 10 seconds and straight away when signal returns. You do nothing.

- The block, tag and action lists are kept on the phone, so the pickers work out in the orchard.
- Actions ticked off without signal are sent with the next sync, dated when you ticked them.
- A badge such as "2 not yet synced" shows at the top while notes wait. It normally clears on its own.
- **Do not leave unsynced notes for days.** If the app sits unused for about a week, iOS can clear its storage and anything not yet synced is lost. After a run of offline notes, open the app somewhere with signal.

9. Backups

The server makes a full backup (notes and photos) every night at 02:00 and keeps the latest 14. It is skipped if the PC is off at that time.

To make one yourself: **Settings** → **Backups** → **Back Up Now**. The button shows "Backing up..." until done. Each backup in the list has a **Download** link.

Message	Meaning
Backup created	Done. The new backup is at the top of the list.
Backup failed - can't reach the server	Check Tailscale and that the server is running.
Backup failed on the server (500)	The server was reached but the backup failed, most often a full disk. Ask whoever looks after the PC.
Backup timed out	It may still be finishing. Wait a minute and check the list before trying again.

> Now and then, copy the latest backup off the server (cloud drive or USB stick). Backups on the same PC do not protect against that PC's disk failing.

10. When something goes wrong

Problem	What to do
"Not yet synced" will not clear	Swipe the app away in the app switcher and reopen it from its icon. If it persists, check Tailscale is connected and the address loads in Safari.
Block is a plain text box, not a list	No blocks have been set up yet. Add them in Settings → Blocks, with signal.
An action ticked off still shows on the other phone	The tick reaches the server with the next sync. Open the app with signal on the phone that ticked it.
AI Tidy up or Ask AI is missing	The server has no AI key yet, or the app has not checked since. Both also need signal.
Add Photo does nothing, or Camera fails	Open the app from the Home Screen icon on the https address. As a fallback, take the photo in the normal Camera app and attach it with Photo Library.
No location on a note	Open from the Home Screen icon. Check Settings → Privacy & Security → Location Services is on and allowed "While Using". Go outdoors and wait a few seconds. The note saves either way.
Location but no weather	Normal when the note was made without signal. Blank means "not known".
Afrikaans comes out as garbled English	That is the keyboard's microphone. Use **Record in Afrikaans** instead.
A note vanished after installing the icon	It was captured in a Safari tab before installing and cannot be moved across. Re-enter it in the installed app.
App looks normal but everything fails (old :8443 icon)	Delete the icon, remove the server from Safari → Settings → Advanced → Website Data, then re-add the icon from the :9443 address.

Quick reference

- ☐ Installed to the Home Screen and opened only from the icon
- ☐ Location and Camera allowed
- ☐ Microphone allowed for **Record in Afrikaans**
- ☐ The farm's blocks set up in Settings → Blocks
- ☐ Title, block, notes, actions and tags filled in, then Save Note
- ☐ Check the To do tab, and tick jobs off when they are done
- ☐ Opened the app with signal after a batch of offline notes
- ☐ Check that "not yet synced" has cleared
- ☐ Copy a backup off the server every so often